Recommendations and Reflection

Streamlining Banking Support Operations | XYZ Investment Bank

1. Recommendations

The analysis identified key challenges in the bank's application support operations, including fragmented knowledge, unclear application ownership, inconsistent escalation processes, and limited operational visibility. The following recommendations address these challenges and support the proposed hybrid onshore-offshore operating model.

1.1 Establish a Centralized Support Operations Capability

Establish a centralized capability to coordinate support activities across the bank's 120+ applications. Clearly defined responsibilities would improve coordination, accountability, and consistency across onshore and offshore teams.

1.2 Standardize Support Processes and Escalation Procedures

Document standard procedures for request submission, assignment, escalation, and resolution tracking. Clearly defined application ownership and escalation responsibilities would reduce ambiguity and improve accountability.

1.3 Develop a Centralized Knowledge Repository

Create a structured repository containing application documentation, standard operating procedures, and troubleshooting guidance. Regular reviews and assigned ownership would help maintain accurate information and reduce dependency on individual employees.

1.4 Improve Request Tracking and Operational Visibility

Introduce consistent request tracking to provide visibility into status, ownership, and outstanding actions. Operational reporting could help identify recurring issues, monitor performance, and support informed decision-making.

1.5 Implement the Proposed Solution Incrementally Using Agile

Use an iterative delivery approach based on business priorities and stakeholder feedback. The proposed epics, user stories, sprint plans, and release roadmap provide a foundation for organizing and prioritizing the work.

1.6 Define Measures of Success

Evaluate the proposed improvements using measures such as request resolution time, escalation frequency, adherence to support procedures, and stakeholder satisfaction. Establish baselines and agree on performance targets before implementation.

These recommendations represent a proposed future-state direction, not an implemented solution. Stakeholder validation, resource planning, and feasibility assessment would be required before implementation.

2. Reflection

This project provided practical experience in applying Business Analysis techniques to an operational challenge. It demonstrated how business problems can be translated into requirements and a proposed future-state solution.

Developing the As-Is Business Model Canvas and process map helped identify operational challenges. Fishbone analysis and stakeholder mapping supported root-cause investigation, while user personas and the To-Be Experience Map helped consider stakeholder needs.

Preparing the Business Requirements Document strengthened my understanding of business, system, functional, and non-functional requirements. Data flow diagrams, user flows, and wireframes helped communicate the proposed solution and illustrate user interactions.

The Agile planning activities developed my understanding of epics, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog prioritization, sprint planning, and release road mapping. Using Jira and Excel helped organize requirements and structure the proposed delivery approach.

Overall, the project reinforced the importance of connecting business needs with clear requirements, stakeholder involvement, and structured delivery planning. It also highlighted the need to validate proposed solutions and measure outcomes before determining their effectiveness.